

69.5 KEY LANGUAGE DEFINITE AND INDEFINITE ARTICLES WITH NAMES

You normally use the zero article with the name of a person.

This is my uncle, Neil Armstrong.



You can use the definite article before a person's name to differentiate them from another person with the same name.

He's not the Neil Armstrong, is he?

[He isn't the famous person with that name, is he?]

In this case, "the" is pronounced "thee."



You can use the indefinite article when the focus is on a particular name, rather than the person.

I'm afraid there isn't a "Joseph Bloggs" on the list.

[The particular name given is not on the list.]



69.6 FILL IN THE GAPS USING THE CORRECT ARTICLES, LEAVING A GAP FOR THE ZERO ARTICLE

The Space Race produced two truly iconic moments in the history of humankind. The first happened on April 12, 1961, when Yuri Gagarin became _____ first human in space. The entire Vostok 1 mission, including one orbit around Earth, lasted only 1 hour 29 minutes. Gagarin's voyage changed how people all over _____ world thought about _____ space.

Just over eight years later in July 1969, _____ Neil Armstrong, "Buzz" Aldrin, and Michael Collins traveled to space in _____ Apollo 11 space craft. On July 20, 1969, Armstrong stepped onto _____ Moon's dusty surface. What he actually said next is _____ interesting story in itself. For many years he argued that he had said, "That's one small step for a man, one giant leap for mankind." After listening to repeated transmission recordings, however, he admitted that he may have dropped the indefinite article "_____." Either way, it was _____ huge step for mankind.

